

Birds

Our songbirds are in their breeding season – plenty of food and lots of daylight. If it weren't for coronavirus it'd be great to join one of RSPB's dawn chorus outings in the woodlands down by Otmoor Reserve (closed). Still we can appreciate the garden birds, specially with the windows open in the warmer weather.

Here they are with hopefully some memory aids to help recognition?

Well-known songbirds:



The Blackbird Very musical. Long mellow, relaxed phrases with good pauses in between. Good for a secretary with pauses to give you time to write them down!



The Song Thrush Another musical sound. Recognisable by its repetitive nature – 2,3 or 4 times, loud and clear. For the secretary again, all repeated several times.



The Robin Sings a phrase then there's a gap then a different phrase everytime.

Slow notes tumble into rapid ones. Sings in Autumn as well.

The Wren Surprisingly loud for such a small bird. Strong, dynamic over 100 notes with a twist at the end.



The Dunnock High-pitched and squeaky like the uncoiled wheels of a trolley. Doesn't have a final trill like the Wren.



The Great Tit Strident and bell-like, just 2 notes repeated with stress on the first. Sounds like **teacher, teacher, teacher, teacher, teacher** or a foot pump.



The Blue Tit A complex song with 2 or 3 notes as an introduction then a trill. Lively and high-pitched.

Birds

The Chaffinch Cheerful rattling which gets louder and faster, drops pitch and ends emphatically. Sounds like a bowler approaching the crease with quickening footsteps and the final delivery of the ball.



The Greenfinch Wheezes and trills, its prolonged wheeze telling you its colour – greeeeeeeeeeeeen!



The Goldfinch Twit twit, dodododo and a trill



The Starling Rambling, gurgling, untidy and mischievous. A very good imitator of others eg a chicken.



The House Sparrow Noisy variety of cheeps and chirrups. Very often in chorus with others.

Reminders



The Great Spotted Woodpecker Feb – May with its dry rattle laughing and of course its drumming.

The Green Woodpecker Unmistakable peal of laughter, a loud yaffle dropping down the scale slightly.



The Wood Pigeon doo-doooh, doo, doo-du doo-doooh, doo, doo-du.



The Collared Dove The bored football fan's "United".